GARP M Functional Impact Evidence Template

Example only for Hypothetical Veteran with Knee Condition, Depression & Anxiety, and Alcohol Use

This template follows the main GARP M lifestyle and functional categories used by DVA assessors and MLCOA. It uses the worst / average / good day structure that is standard for describing fluctuating conditions. Copy and adapt with your own details for statutory declarations, MLCOA summaries, or medical reports.

How to Use This Template

- Replace the example text in [square brackets] with your own details.
- Keep the structure (Bad Day / Average Day / Good Day) – this is the accepted way to show variability.
- Map your evidence to the GARP M categories below so assessors can easily rate lifestyle effects.
- This aligns with the Emotional & Behavioural Worksheet and lifestyle effects tables in GARP M.

Self-Care and Personal Hygiene

Bad Day (approx. 3–4 times per week)

- Severe knee pain + mental blackhole means I cannot shower, change clothes, or perform basic hygiene.
- Stay in bed or on the couch most of the day; completely dependent on others for essential tasks.
- [Add your details here]

Average Day

- Can manage only very basic self-care (quick shower) with significant effort and pacing.
- Often skip grooming or proper meals due to low motivation and pain.
- [Add your details here]

Good Day (rare – approx. once every 2–3 weeks)

- Slightly better but still limited; basic self-care takes effort and I pay for it later.
- [Add your details here]

Mobility and Travel

Bad Day

- Knee pain so severe I can barely walk or stand for more than a few minutes.
- Cannot leave the house or drive; completely housebound.
- [Add your details here]

Average Day

- Can walk short distances (100–200 m) with pain and frequent rests; avoid stairs and uneven ground.
- Only leave the house for essential medical appointments.
- [Add your details here]

Good Day

- Knee pain more manageable; can do one short outing but still very limited.
- [Add your details here]

Household and Domestic Activities

Bad Day

- Cannot prepare food, clean, do laundry, or manage any household tasks.
- [Add your details here]

Average Day

- Can do only the most basic tasks (microwave meal); anything more requires long rests or is avoided.
- [Add your details here]

Good Day

- May complete one small task with pacing, but cannot sustain normal household activity.
- [Add your details here]

Social and Recreational Activities

Bad Day

- Complete withdrawal – cannot engage in any social or recreational activity.
- [Add your details here]

Average Day

- Avoid almost all social and recreational activities; feel overwhelmed by the idea of them.
- [Add your details here]

Good Day

- Slightly more able to have very short, planned interactions, but still very limited.
- [Add your details here]

Personal Relationships and Social Functioning

Bad Day

- Cannot interact with family or friends; feel completely disconnected and hopeless.
- [Add your details here]

Average Day

- Strained relationships; avoid phone calls and family contact; feel flat and irritable.
- [Add your details here]

Good Day

- Slightly better tolerance for short interactions, but still very limited and exhausting.
- [Add your details here]

Concentration, Task Completion and Cognitive Function

Bad Day

- Mental blackhole – no concentration, motivation, or ability to make decisions or start tasks.
- [Add your details here]

Average Day

- Poor concentration and motivation; struggle to start or finish even small tasks.
- [Add your details here]

Good Day

- Slightly better focus, but still reduced compared to a healthy person.
- [Add your details here]

Employability and Work Capacity

Bad / Average / Good Days

- Unable to sustain any form of work, volunteering, or study on any type of day.
- Conditions (knee pain + depression/anxiety + alcohol use) reinforce each other and prevent reliable functioning.
- [Add your details here – e.g. last worked, attempts at light duties, reasons for stopping]

How This Aligns with GARP M

These categories match the main domains used in the GARP M Emotional & Behavioural Worksheet and lifestyle effects tables (self-care, mobility, social functioning, concentration, employability, etc.). Describing fluctuations with Bad / Average / Good days is the standard and expected method for chronic and intermittent conditions.

Tip: Use this template as the basis for your statutory declaration or a one-page summary to give to MLCOA or your treating doctor. Keep language specific and consistent with your medical records.

— End of Template —

Created for veteran advocacy use • Adapt with your own details • Aligns with current GARP M

Bibliography (AGLC4)

1. Department of Veterans' Affairs, Guide to Determining Impairment and Compensation (GARP M) — lifestyle effects and Emotional & Behavioural Worksheet.

Daily Fluctuation Summary Template

Short Version – Generic Veteran (Knee + Depression/Anxiety + Alcohol Use)

This is a quick 1-page version. Copy into your statutory declaration or give to MLCOA. Use the Bad / Average / Good day structure – this is the standard way DVA expects fluctuating conditions to be described.

Bad Day (approx. 3–4 times per week)

- Severe knee pain + mental blackhole + heavy drinking to cope
- Stay in bed/couch most of the day – cannot shower, cook, leave house, or interact with family
- Completely non-functional; blackouts or passing out from alcohol
- [Your details here]

Average Day

- Knee pain and stiffness; limited walking; poor sleep from pain + alcohol
- Low motivation, flat mood, anxiety in background; avoid social contact and most tasks
- Drink most evenings to cope; affects next-day functioning
- Can only manage very basic self-care and simple microwave meals
- [Your details here]

Good Day (rare – approx. once every 2–3 weeks)

- Knee pain more manageable; slightly better mood and motivation
- Can do one small task or short outing, but still very limited
- Still usually drink in the evening; know I will pay for extra activity later
- [Your details here]

Overall Impact

- Major loss of independence across self-care, mobility, household tasks, social functioning, and work capacity
- Conditions reinforce each other (pain → worse mood → more drinking → poorer functioning)
- Withdrawn from almost all social, family, and productive activities
- [Your details here – overall effect on your life]

— End of Short Template —

Adapt with your own details • Use in statutory declarations or MLCOA summaries • Aligns with GARP M

Intermittent & Fluctuating Conditions

Evidence Template – GARP M Principles + Daily Fluctuation Method

GARP M recognises that many conditions are intermittent or fluctuate over time (see principles in Chapter 15 and general guidance on averaging). The most practical and accepted way to capture this for assessors is the Bad / Average / Good day structure. This template combines both approaches.

How to Present Fluctuating Conditions (Standard Method)

- Describe frequency (e.g. “Bad days occur 3–4 times per week” or “Most days are average with occasional good days”).
- Give concrete examples of what you CANNOT do on each type of day (self-care, mobility, household, social, concentration, work).
- Show how the conditions interact and reinforce each other.
- This method is used across physical pain, mental health, and substance use conditions – it is not limited to “intermittent injuries”.

Example Structure (Generic Veteran – Knee + Depression/Anxiety + Alcohol)

Bad Day (approx. 3–4 times per week)

- Severe knee pain + mental blackhole + heavy drinking to cope
- Stay in bed/couch most of the day – cannot shower, cook, leave house, or engage with family
- Blackouts or passing out; next day is even worse (hangover + increased pain + deeper depression)
- [Your details here]

Average Day

- Knee pain/stiffness limits walking and standing; poor sleep from pain + alcohol
- Low motivation, flat mood, background anxiety; avoid social contact and most tasks
- Drink most evenings to cope – affects next-day energy, pain, and mood
- Only basic self-care and simple meals possible
- [Your details here]

Good Day (rare – approx. once every 2–3 weeks)

- Knee pain more manageable; slightly better mood and motivation
- Can do one small task or short outing, but still very limited and I pay for it later
- Still usually drink in the evening
- [Your details here]

Overall Impact & Intermittent Nature

- Conditions are chronic but fluctuate significantly day-to-day and week-to-week.
- Bad periods can last several days in a row; good periods are short and unpredictable.
- The combination of physical pain, mental health, and alcohol use creates a reinforcing cycle that prevents sustained functioning.
- [Your details here – how long bad periods last, how unpredictable good days are, overall effect on your life]

— End of Template —

Use this structure in statutory declarations and MLCOA summaries • Aligns with GARP M intermittent impairment principles + daily fluctuation method